number of JKLF members and led the Indian security forces to the hideouts of others.[21] The JKLF's capabilities were severely reduced by the end of 1991, and by 1993 HM was the dominant guerrilla organization in the field. India freed Yasin Malik, the head of the JKLF in Indian-administered Kashmir, from prison a year later. Malik called for demilitarization and unconditional talks following his release.[22] With the exit of the JKLF from the battlefield, all of the remaining major militant players aspired to accession.[23]

Pakistan was supporting a host of other smaller militant organizations as well as HM by this time. This accomplished two objectives. First, it ensured that all of Pakistan's eggs were not in one basket. If one group were infiltrated and destroyed, others could step in and fill the void. Second, supporting multiple groups meant no one organization grew so strong that it could threaten Pakistan's interests. A side effect of Pakistan's policy was that it naturally encouraged the country's myriad proxies to compete with one another. As is often the case, militants expended much effort fighting with one another rather than against the common enemy. To bring a degree of unity to the cause, the All Parties Hurriyat Conference [APHC] was established in 1993 and the United Jihad Council [UJC] formed in 1994. The former was an umbrella organization for the Kashmiri political parties opposed to Indian rule; the latter was a similar umbrella organization for militant groups fighting against India. HM dominated both organizations, but by this time its paramount status among militant groups was beginning to wane as was the boom period of the armed uprising in the Valley.[24] Although HM lost market share to non-indigenous groups, it remained the largest outfit operating in Indian-administered Kashmir and retained significant influence. However, HM's peak years were behind it by the mid-1990s.

Foreign militants, or 'guest mujahideen' as they were called, had been present in Indian-administered Kashmir as early as 1990.[25] At first they were often integrated into local groups and it was not until the communist Democratic Republic of Afghanistan fell in 1992 that they started appearing en masse. The ISI encouraged and supported the entrance of non-indigenous jihadi groups formed for the Afghan jihad into the Kashmir front for several reasons.[26] To begin with, India's counter-insurgency efforts had improved remarkably since the insurgency began. New Delhi